



Holland Risley
4 Amberley Gardens,
Kingsteignton
Devon
United Kingdom
TQ12 3RU

Our Ref: MW09731

19 August 2025

Dear Holland,

An Open Letter to the Residents of Kingsteignton

I am sharing with you the open letter that I have written to residents (below) about the recent proposals by Sibelco to quarry the Zitherixon site near Kingsteignton.

Over the past weeks, I have listened closely to residents, and it is clear just how deeply people care about the environmental and social impact this proposal could have on our town. I've heard your concerns about the potential effects on our natural landscape – particularly the loss of trees, risks of flooding, threats to local wildlife, and the broader impact on biodiversity and conservation efforts. I also understand the serious worries around noise, vibration, dust, and disruption that could affect nearby homes, schools, and daily life in Kingsteignton.

To better understand these concerns, I have met with members of the Save Our Trees campaign and **Newton Abbot Rugby Club**, both of whom have shared with me how this proposal could affect them and the wider community. I also attended the recent public consultation at the racecourse held by Sibelco to hear directly from residents and see the proposed plans first-hand.

I want to assure you that I will continue working to ensure all local concerns are heard and fully considered. Any permissions given must be based on a clear and robust plan to protect our community and environment. Of particular importance are questions around how Sibelco intends to achieve the legally required **10% biodiversity net gain**, how they will manage potential **flood risks**, and how **wildlife connectivity** will be preserved with any trees removed.

It is also crucial that local homes, schools, and infrastructure are shielded from any excessive levels of noise, dust, or disruption. This must include rigorous, ongoing monitoring and clear accountability, so that action can be taken swiftly if agreed limits are breached.

As things currently stand, Sibelco holds the mineral rights; a range of planning permissions along with a scoping opinion granted in 2023 for the Zitherixon extension. They will need to go back to **Devon County Council** to seek more planning permissions for the site which will need to detail the environmental impact of the works and their proposals to deal with it. They will be required to provide a full environmental statement. It is vital that this is fully scrutinised to ensure they do the least harm possible, while delivering on all environmental and community commitments.

While Parliamentary protocols prevent MPs from intervening directly in local planning decisions, I will explore any opportunity to raise your concerns in Parliament where appropriate.

I encourage all residents to continue making your voices heard – particularly to your **County Councillors**, who have key roles to play in representing your views during planning.

Please be assured that I will remain engaged with all parties involved. My commitment is to stand with our community and help secure the best possible outcome for Kingsteignton – one that respects both the needs of residents and the environment we all value.

Best regards,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading 'Martin Wrigley' with a stylized flourish at the end.

Martin Wrigley MP
Member of Parliament for Newton Abbot
House of Commons | Westminster | London | SW1A 0AA